Accessibility conformance report: Information Systems Technology, Associate of Applied Science (Blue Ridge Community College)

Prepared 2026-11-13. Source file: brcc-ist-program.pdf (4 pages). Remediated file: brcc-ist-program.pdf.

Summary

Before and after remediation

Check	Before	After
PDF/UA-1 machine validation (veraPDF, ISO 14289-1)	Fails: 7 rules, 255 failed checks	Passes
Tagged structure	Yes	Yes
Document language	en	en-US
Document title shown in title bar	Information Systems Technology	Information Systems Technology, Associate of Applied Science (Blue Ridge Community College)
Bookmarks	0	0
Images with alternative text		0 of 0 tagged figures
Form fields with labels		No form fields
Text recognised from scanned images (OCR)		Not needed
Visual change (share of pixels that differ, worst page)		0.0000

Visual change is measured by rendering every page before and after and counting pixels that differ. A value near zero means the document looks the same to a sighted reader. Small non-zero values come from embedding the fonts the original only named.

What we promise, and what we do not

- The remediated file passes PDF/UA-1 machine validation in veraPDF, the reference open-source validator, unless this report says otherwise.
- The structure (headings, lists, tables, reading order) was reviewed against the page, and every image and form field was reviewed and described or labelled.
- This is not a certification and not a legal opinion. Machine validation cannot judge whether alternative text or reading order is right; that part rests on the review described below.
- Colour contrast is measured and reported, not changed.

Structure of the remediated document

Tagged elements by type

Element	Count
H1	1
H2	2
H3	8
Link	20
P	32

TD	324
TH	24
TR	116
Table	8

Headings, in reading order

- Level 1: INFORMATION SYSTEMS TECHNOLOGY
- Level 2: Required Courses
- Level 3: Curriculum
- Level 2: Certificates
- Level 3: Cybersecurity and Networking Foundations
- Level 3: Intermediate Cybersecurity
- Level 3: Cloud Computing
- Level 3: Information Technology for Business
- Level 3: Foundations in Digital Design and Graphics
- Level 3: Cybersecurity
- Level 3: Information Technology

Machine validation in detail

Failures in the original file

Rule (ISO 14289-1 clause)	What it checks	Failed checks
5-1	The PDF/UA version and conformance level of a file shall be specified using the PDF/UA Identification extension schema	1
7.1-3	Content shall be marked as Artifact or tagged as real content	208
7.1-9	The Metadata stream in the document's catalog dictionary shall contain a dc:title entry, where dc is the recommended prefix for the Dublin C	1
7.18.1-2	An annotation (except Widget annotations or hidden annotations, or those having rectangle outside the crop-box) shall have either Contents k	20
7.18.5-2	Links shall contain an alternate description via their Contents key as described in ISO 32000-1:2008, 14.9.3	20
7.21.4.2-2	If the FontDescriptor dictionary of an embedded CID font contains a CIDSet stream, then it shall identify all CIDs which are present in the	4
7.5-1	If the table's structure is not determinable via Headers and IDs, then structure elements of type TH shall have a Scope attribute	1

No PDF/UA-1 failures remain in the remediated file.

Colour contrast (WCAG 2.1, success criterion 1.4.3)

No text run measured below the required contrast ratio.

Checks that machine validation cannot settle (Matterhorn Protocol)

Review checks

Checkpoint	Status	How
01 Real content tagged, decoration marked as artifact	Not yet reviewed	Tag tree compared with the rendered pages.

06/09 Logical reading order and appropriate tags	Not yet reviewed	Reading order and tag types checked in the tag dump against the page images.
13 Alternative text for figures is meaningful	Not yet reviewed	Every image reviewed; alt text written for meaningful images, decorative images marked as artifacts.
14 Headings: levels reflect the document's outline	Enforced by script	Engine never skips a level; heading text checked in review.
15 Tables: headers and scope	Not yet reviewed	Header cells and scope checked in the tag dump.
16 Lists tagged as lists	Not yet reviewed	List structure checked in the tag dump.
28 Form fields have labels; tab order follows structure	Enforced by script	Every field has a tooltip (TU); page tab order set to structure order.
31 Text maps to correct Unicode (including OCR text)	Enforced by script	Fonts carry ToUnicode maps; OCR text spot-checked against the image.
WCAG 1.4.3 Colour contrast (outside PDF/UA)	Measured by script	Measured by script for every text run; reported below, not changed (changing colours changes how the document looks).
Usability with a screen reader (NVDA, JAWS) in Adobe Acrobat Reader	Not done	Not part of this deliverable unless stated: no screen-reader session was recorded for this file.

Known limitations of this file

- Where a row leaves a cell empty (for example, the course options under "Select one of the following" carry no credit hours), the cell beside it is tagged as spanning that column.
- Two elective rows whose text runs across the code and title columns are tagged with all of that text in the code column.

Tools

veraPDF 1.30.4 (PDF/UA-1 validation); qpdf and pikepdf (PDF structure); PyMuPDF (layout and rendering); OCRmyPDF with Tesseract (text recognition, when needed); LibreOffice (this report). All run locally.

The full structure tree in reading order is supplied as a separate text file.